

Hartsfield Business Bank

Company Backstory

Hartsfield Business Bank was founded in 1999 by Calvin Reeves, a former SunTrust commercial loan officer who spent 12 years watching small business owners in Atlanta get handed to call centers, buried in paperwork, and turned down by institutions that didn't understand what it meant to run a family business in the South.

Calvin grew up in College Park — the neighborhood that sits in the shadow of Hartsfield-Jackson — watching planes take off from his backyard and listening to his mother talk about her catering business like it was a living thing that needed care, not just capital. When she was denied a line of credit in 1991 because her "revenue was seasonal," he made a decision he wouldn't revisit: one day he'd build a bank that understood what it actually meant to run a business in Atlanta.

He opened the first Hartsfield Business Bank branch on Metropolitan Parkway in 2001 with seven employees, a single conference room he rented out to local entrepreneurs for pitch meetings on Saturdays, and a loan approval process he designed himself — one that weighted owner character and community ties alongside credit scores.

By 2010, Hartsfield had three branches across metro Atlanta — College Park, Decatur, and Buckhead — and had become the go-to institution for the kind of businesses that kept Atlanta running: restaurant groups, logistics contractors, construction firms, medical practices, creative agencies, and the sprawling network of Black-owned businesses that had been building generational wealth in this city for decades without adequate banking support.

By 2024, Hartsfield Business Bank had grown to \$2.1 billion in assets, nine branch locations across metro Atlanta and two in Savannah, and a reputation that no national bank could manufacture: they showed up. When a restaurant group in Edgewood needed a bridge loan during COVID and every national bank said no, Hartsfield said yes in 72 hours. When a logistics startup in Forest Park needed a banking partner that understood their seasonal cash flow cycles, Hartsfield built a custom account structure around their business model instead of asking them to change their model to fit a product.

Twenty-five years in, the bank Calvin Reeves built from a College Park conference room is the largest Black-led community bank in Georgia and the most trusted small business banking institution in metro Atlanta. And now, for the first time in its history, it is going fully digital — without losing a single thing that made it matter.